

If, during a file-by-file copy, the Finder discovers that a file already exists on the target disk with the same name as a file being copied, it will display an alert (Figure 6F) to find out how to handle the duplicate file. You can choose to Skip or Replace this item only (the Finder will display another alert when it encounters another duplicate file), to Skip or Replace all duplicates the Finder encounters during the operation, or to Cancel the entire copy operation.

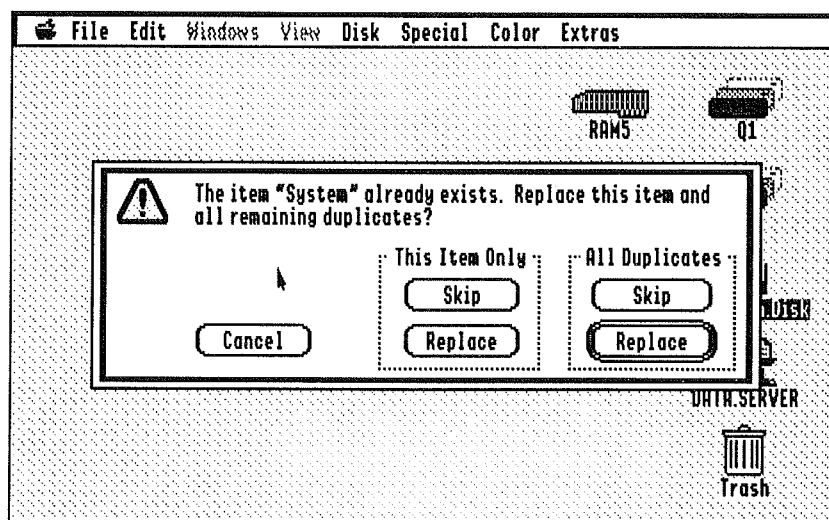


Figure 6F—Replace/Skip Duplicate Files Dialog

Initializing & Erasing Disks

Initializing and erasing disks are two very similar operations the Finder can perform on disks. Both have the effect of completely erasing every bit of information on the disk. Usually you *initialize* blank disks that have never been used; you *erase* disks that have already been initialized but have data on them that you no longer need. The procedures for the two operations are nearly identical, so we'll cover them together.

Warning!

Remember, both "Initialize" and "Erase" will totally erase everything on the disk. In the case of "Erase" some data recovery may be possible with programs like ProSel-16 or Salvation-Deliverance, but usually your data will be gone for good. So be careful!

Warning!

The Finder will automatically attempt to format blank 3.5" disks inserted in a 3.5" drive. If you insert a disk which is supposed to have information on it and the Finder asks you if you want to initialize it, the disk is probably damaged. Unless you really do want to initialize the disk, we suggest clicking the "Eject" button so that any remaining data can be salvaged by a disk repair utility such as ProSel-16 or Salvation-Deliverance.